What makes Twig better than PHP as a template engine?

When it comes to template engines in PHP, many people will tell you that PHP itself is a template engine. But even if PHP started its life as a template language, it did not evolve like one in the recent years. As a matter of fact, it doesn't support many features modern template engines should have nowadays:

- **Concise**: The PHP language is verbose and becomes ridiculously verbose when it comes to output escaping:



```
<?php echo $var ?>
<?php echo htmlspecialchars($var, ENT_QUOTES, 'UTF-8') ?>
```

  In comparison, Twig has a very concise syntax, which make templates more readable:

```
{{ var }}
{{ var|raw }}     {# var won't be escaped #}
```

- **Template oriented syntax** Twig has shortcuts for common patterns, like having a default text displayed when you iterate over an empty array:

```
{% for user in users %}
    * {{ user.name }}
```

```
<figure class="image_container">
  <a href="<?= $this->href ?>" title="<?= $this->title ?>">
    <?php $this->insert('picture_default', $this->picture); ?>
  </a>

  <?php if ($this->caption): ?>
    <figcaption class="caption"><?= $this->caption ?></figcaption>
  <?php endif; ?>
</figure>
```